

Choose the correct tense: Past simple vs continuous

1. I (watched / was watching) TV when the doorbell (rang / was ringing).
2. They (played / were playing) football at 5 p.m. yesterday.
3. She (fell / was falling) while she (ran / was running) to school.
4. We (ate / were eating) dinner when the guests (arrived / were arriving).
5. He (studied / was studying) when his mother (came in / was coming in).
6. I (met / was meeting) an old friend while I (walked / was walking) home.
7. The children (slept / were sleeping) when the storm (started / was starting).
8. She (dropped / was dropping) her phone while she (got / was getting) off the bus.
9. We (didn't notice / weren't noticing) the sign because we (talked / were talking).
10. He (hurt / was hurting) his back when he (lifted / was lifting) the box.

2. Put the verbs into the correct tense (present simple OR present continuous):

The train always _____ (1: leave) on time. "What's the matter? Why _____ (2: cry/you)?" That's strange. They _____ (3: not to watch) TV. He _____ (4: not to speak) very good English. Please be quiet! I _____ (5: do) my homework. Where _____ (6: live/they)? Listen! John _____ music! (7: play) I never _____ (8: go) to the swimming pool. Harold Black's a famous pianist. He _____ (9: give) two or three concerts every week. He _____ (10: travel) a lot and this week he's in New York. He _____ (11: stay) at an expensive hotel. He's at his hotel now. He _____ (12: have) his breakfast in the dining-room. He _____ (13: drink) a cup of coffee and he _____ (14: read) a newspaper. Harold's always very busy. He _____ (15: play) the piano regularly. He _____ (16: practise) for four hours every day. He _____ (17: go) to bed late and he always _____ (18: get up) early. But he sometimes _____ (19: get) dressed too quickly, and this morning he _____ (20: wear) one blue sock and one red one!

FUTURE TENSES EXERCISES Fill in the correct future tense - will future, going to or present continuous.

1. They _____ (drive) to New York tomorrow morning.
2. I hope the weather _____ (be) nice.
3. I offered him this job. I think he _____ (take) it.

4. I promise I _____ (not tell) your secret to anyone.
5. Take your umbrella with you. It _____ (rain).
6. They _____ (play) cards this evening.
7. I _____ (go) to the cinema tomorrow.
8. They _____ (fly) to Seattle next summer holidays.
9. I _____ (invite) 50 people to the party, and I hope everyone _____ (come).
10. That exercise looks difficult. I _____ (help) you.
11. _____ he _____ (go) to the football match?
12. Are you sure they _____ (win) the match?
13. She _____ probably _____ (stay) till Thursday.
14. He _____ (not leave) tomorrow.
15. We think he _____ (come) home late in the night.